

Ailani Sato-Lim

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Education

University of California, Berkeley (GPA: 3.977) 2021-2025

B.A., Cognitive Science (Highest Honors)

Minor: Buddhist Studies

Advisors: Eve Sweetser, Robert Sharf

Honors Thesis: "Intellectual Nets and the Fish of Delusion: Metaphors of Buddhist Modernism"

Fellowship and Awards

Robert J. Glushko Prize for Distinguished Undergraduate Research, UC Berkeley 2025

Phi Beta Kappa, Alpha of California 2025

UC Berkeley Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (\$5,000) 2024

Khyentse Foundation Award for Academic Excellence in Buddhist Studies (\$1,500) 2024

Conference Presentations

Sato-Lim, A. (2025 August). "Intellectual Nets and the Fish of Delusion: Metaphors of Buddhist Modernism." **Poster presentation**, 17th Annual Researching and Applying Metaphor Conference at Lawrence Technological University, Springfield, MI.

Sato-Lim, A. (2024 August). "Unfolding the Mind: How Conceptual Metaphors for Self Shape American Buddhism." **Conference talk**, Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship Conference at the University of California, Berkeley.

Research Experience

Research Assistant for the MetaNet Project (University of British Columbia) Spring 2024

Mentor: Dr. Eve Sweetser

Assisted in metaphor analysis on the discourse about climate change and COVID-19

Collected textual data from far-right media and online discussion forums; categorized metaphors based on religious source frames (e.g., altar, cult, saints, gospel, etc.)

Research Assistant at Language and Cognitive Development Lab (UC Berkeley) 2023 - 2024

PI: Mahesh Srinivasan; Mentor: Sophie Reagan

Investigating How Children Understand the Connection Between Language and Social Cues

Assisted in the study design and creation of test stimuli and collected data through in-person testing of participants ages 4-6 at local museums and libraries

Organized surveys with Qualtrics; performed data entry, coding, and analysis on Sharepoint and Excel

Presented preliminary results and further directions at lab-wide meeting

Research Assistant, Developing Belief Network (UC Berkeley | UC Santa Cruz)

Spring 2023

PIs: Mahesh Srinivasan, Audun Dahl

Coded data of audio files on Box

Work Experience

Project Manager and Web Designer for Platform Justice (Nonprofit)

July 2025 - Present

Private Yoga Instructor

June 2024 - Present

Freelance Frontend Developer and Designer

July 2025 - Present

Barista at RareTea Berkeley

2021, 2023-2025

Skills

Programming R, Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, SQL

Tools Jupyter Notebook, Qualtrics, Adobe Suite, Google Suite

Languages Japanese (native), Spanish (Intermediate)